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Chapter 2

Advanced Order Entry Overview



Introduction

Information is the key to good customer service and to ensuring that a sales opportunity is converted to an order. The Advanced Order Entry module provides a variety of functions and techniques that enhance the selling process.

The dialogue with the customer might start as a simple pricing or availability enquiry that may be converted into a quotation or an order. This order can be satisfied from stock, reserved against an incoming purchase order, ordered from a supplier for direct delivery to the customer, or satisfied by creating a production order in Production.

There is a wide range of enquiry facilities available, in addition to reports that enhance those available in Sales Order Processing.

Application Configuration

As with all modules Advanced Order Entry can be operated for a number of companies. In this module, however, the characteristics are maintained on the control files of the Inventory Management and Sales Order Processing modules. It follows therefore that these must be installed and configured prior to the installation of Advanced Order Entry. Inventory Management, Sales Order Processing, Accounts Receivable and Sales Analysis all share a common company with Advanced Order Entry.

Search Families And Certificates Of Conformance

Item characteristics such as colour or thickness can be used to describe any inventory item. These characteristics are identified by a search family code.

Certificates Of Conformance use the same characteristics used by the search family codes and can be maintained for each lot of a lot controlled item.

When allocating stock to a customer in Advanced Order Entry, the characteristics of all available lots can be studied, and the lot which most suits the customer's need can be the one actually allocated.

Lot Reference Maintenance

You can create and maintain lot details for batch/lot/serial controlled items. These details include Certificate Of Conformance references, supplier's reference numbers, expiry dates and potency. This information can assist in selecting the appropriate batch for any customer order.

Relationship to Other Modules

The Advanced Order Entry module is a fully standardised module and as such operates under the control of the Application Manager. It is one of a group of advanced modules that extend the functionality of base modules. The following modules are pre-requisites to the operation of Advanced Order Entry:

- Sales Order Processing
- Inventory Management
- Purchase Management
- Requisitioning
- Accounts Receivable

Some of the module reference data for Advanced Order Entry is set up in Inventory Management and Sales Order Processing.

Advanced Order Entry is designed as an extension to Sales Order Processing. Typically, orders are entered and amended in the Advanced Order Entry module and then processed through to invoicing in Sales Order Processing.

However, Advanced Order Entry extends the normal sources of supply from Inventory stockrooms to, for example, purchase orders, direct deliveries and configuration to order (if Configurator is attached).

The function of Enquiries and Reports is automatically extended to display the result of the additional facilities such as allocation to Inventory batches or back to back sales and purchase orders.

Stock can be reserved against purchase orders set up in Purchase Management and requisitions set up in Purchase Requisitioning for 'purchase to order' and 'direct delivery' orders. Production orders are created in Manufacturing for 'made to order' and 'configure to order' order methods.

Sales Order Processing

Use of order entry and maintenance routines within Sales Order Processing are affected by the implementation of Advanced Order Entry; and controls may be effected via the company profile. In addition, Advanced Pricing set up within Sales Order Processing affects order entry routines in both Sales Order Processing and Advanced Order Entry.

There are three levels of impact in a company when AOE is live:

- Maintenance
- Processing
- Enquiries

Maintenance

- extra fields in company profile. (2/DSCO or 1/OEU)
- need to set up a default customer.(1/ARM and 2/OEM)

Processing

- conversational order entry cannot be used. (2/OEP)
- transcription order amendment cannot be used. (5/OEP)
- conversational order amendment cannot be used. (6/OEP)
- manual allocation (3/OEP) has an extra field Allocate Batch which allows allocation against one or more batches to be carried out. This might be used for orders entered by the transcription method.



*Note: Transcription order entry can still be used
(1/OEP) all order amendment must be done
through AOE (2/AOP)*

Enquiries

All enquiries which display the whole order summary screen (1/OEE) have the following changes to the lines summaries:-

- the order line Typ (type) is displayed (blank for an item allocated from stock; RS for a line which is to be allocated, or partially allocated, by reserving stock from an outstanding purchase order; BB for a line which is to be allocated from a back-to-back purchase order; DD for direct delivery.
- an order line can be selected with a 2 to display batch allocation details
- an order line can be selected with a 3 to show reservation details
- with a 4 on a reserved line, the actual Purchase Order Enquiry may be displayed

Conversational Order Entry

Advanced Order Entry replaces the Conversational Order Entry method in Sales Order Processing. Conversational Order Entry is not available when Advanced Order Entry is in use.

Transcriptional Order Entry

The Transcriptional Order Entry method is available whether or not Advanced Order Entry is in use.

Order Amend

The Order Amend procedure in Advanced Order Entry must be used to amend orders when Advanced Order Entry is live. The Order Amend procedure in Sales Order Processing is not available when Advanced Order Entry is in use.

Company Profile Advanced Order Entry Functions

The following profile screens require review:

- Maintenance Screen 2 Advanced Order Entry functions (**F15**)
- You can specify whether to show mark-ups and to display margins. You can also specify how margin calculation is carried out and define lower and upper margin tolerance. It is here that the default customer (which can be used for quotations and enquiries) and the default customer search type is defined.

Advanced Pricing

Advanced Pricing affects a number of screens; mainly with regard to the displaying of additional fields or additional functions/options:

Select Screen

If Advanced Pricing is in use, Price lists and the Discount list are not displayed.

Header Screen

Displays fields for Price Type, Discount Types, Discount Percentages and Discount Presentation

Order Lines Screen

Enables a Pricing Details option, and a repricing function

Pricing Detail Enquiry

This additional enquiry shows price and all appropriate discounts.

Order Line Overrides

Various additional fields are available: Price Type, Fixed Price, Per and Discounts.

Discounts Window

Displays additional fields: Discount Type, Discount %, Presentation, Discount Value and Discount Value Per.

Order Amend

Screens within Advanced Order Entry (with Advanced Pricing in use) are the same as within Order Entry.

Inventory Management

The Inventory Management company profile is used to activate Advanced Order Entry within a selected company. Once AOE is turned on there are three levels of impact within Inventory:

- Maintenance
- Processing
- Enquiry

Maintenance

Extra fields need to be maintained in:

- Stockroom Codes File (1/DSCO or 2/INU)
- Item File (2/INM)
- Also extra codes need to be maintained in the Descriptions File (1/INM).

Processing

- Enhanced Item Search

Enquiry

On the 'Item/Stockroom enquiry' stockroom details screen (3/INE), Reserved is now displayed. This 'Reserved' value indicates the quantity of the item that has been reserved against an outstanding purchase order.

Company Profile

The following profile screens require review:

- Maintenance Screen 1 SOP in Use flag
- Enter a 2 (AOE attached) against the 'SOP in Use' field.
- Maintenance Screen 1 Extended Options (F10)
- Here you specify whether orders can be accepted with decimal quantities, and define the default item search criteria in AOE.
- Stockroom Extended Options
- This screen allows you to control how stock is allocated.

Descriptions File

A number of codes must be set up in this file in order for Advanced Order Entry to operate, for example quotation types and Certificate Of Conformance requirement codes.

Item Maintenance

For any item you can identify search family and Certificate Of Conformance codes, the preferred supplier and if appropriate, the non-stock item type. You also define whether Certificates Of Conformance are required and the default order type (for example, normal or direct delivery).

Item Maintenance Alternative Item References

You can set up alternative item references such as supplier or customer item codes for any item.

Item Maintenance Item Search Characteristics

This option enables you to set up and maintain the values and descriptions of the search characteristics for an item.

Stockroom Details Maintenance

This option provides for the creation and maintenance of details related to the stocking of an item in a stockroom.

Purchase Management

There are two levels of impact in any company when AOE is live:

- Processing
- Enquiries

Processing

- Back-to-back orders in AOE generate requisitions. These requisitions can be amended, if required in the usual way (11/RQP) and then firmed up to purchase orders in the usual way (31/RQP)
- In goods receiving (43/PMP) **F17=Batch Maintenance** is available, so that batch details can be created as an order line is being received. Also an order line can be selected with a 3 to show reservation details.

Enquiries

In all enquiries which display the Order Summary screen (11-14/PMP and 16-17/PMP) you can now select an order line with option 4 to display reservation details.

Additional Functions

As this is an advanced module, so much of the primary data has already been set up during implementation of the base modules. There are, however, additional functions provided that require the entry of specific data in order to exploit them. These are:

- Enhanced item search.
This replaces the standard item search for a company when Advanced Order Entry is installed and active.
- Item attributes.
This is a set of attributes that class the item.
- Alternative item references.
These could be a customer or supplier reference
- Certificate of Conformance (C of Cs)
Details of C of Cs that have been received can be held within the system and used for reference purposes.

Enhanced Item Search

Items may be identified by any of the following:

- Displaying a list of items starting at an item code or part item code
- Displaying a list of items using up to six part words matched from the item description and external text.
- Displaying a list of items using up to six matches on words or parts of words from the purchase item description.
- Displaying a list of items that meet the attributes entered for the search
- Displaying a list of items that have an alternative item number that matches an entered alternative item reference or part reference

The following two methods are only available if Advanced Order Entry is installed.

- Displaying a list of configured items that have a base item code that matches the entered data. This option is only available if Production and Configurator are installed.
- The installation of Advanced Order Entry enables the maintenance of item attributes and alternative item references in the Inventory Management module.

Item Attributes

An item can be assigned a set of attributes that class the item. For example sheet metal might be:

- Colour
- Material
- Surface Finish
- Width

The attributes for a particular item are then set up during item maintenance. Thus all the items of a given colour, material and surface finish can be identified.

Alternative Item Reference

During item maintenance it is possible to create and maintain any number of alternative item references or codes. Typically these might be a customer item number or an OEM (Original Equipment Manufacturer's) code.

Certificates Of Conformance

Increasingly with the emphasis on quality, it is necessary to be able to record the specification and test results of an item or batch. Advanced Order Entry provides up to ten attributes for a class of items together with the specific test results and the certificate number. This can then be linked to a particular lot. Selection is provided to find those lots that have the required qualities.

Processing

When the order entry option is selected from the processing menu, access is provided to a whole range of order taking facilities, enquiries and sourcing methods, so it is possible to respond to the wishes of the customer, as questions are asked. These facilities may be used to answer an enquiry on price, on availability or to raise an order. This enables a call which starts as an enquiry to move to a quotation and finish as a sales call.

When the order entry function is selected, an opportunity is provided to identify and select the customer or an item. The default customer will be picked up if no actual customer code is selected so that a general quotation can be generated.

In many cases customers have specific terms and agreements. If these are to be taken into account when an enquiry is being made, then it is better to make the enquiry specific to the customer, as opposed to making a general enquiry. Pricing and availability can be checked in either case.

At any time during the dialogue with the customer, it is possible to select the option to say that an order or quotation is to be created. If an order is being created, access is provided to order overrides, such as delivery due date, delivery method, default price lists, discount lists and stockrooms.

When a customer is identified, the standard checks for credit stop and credit limit are performed. If the dialogue closes with an order being generated, then a credit limit check is performed at order close. An item may be one of the following:

- Stock item
- Non-stock item
- Kit
- Kit created during order entry

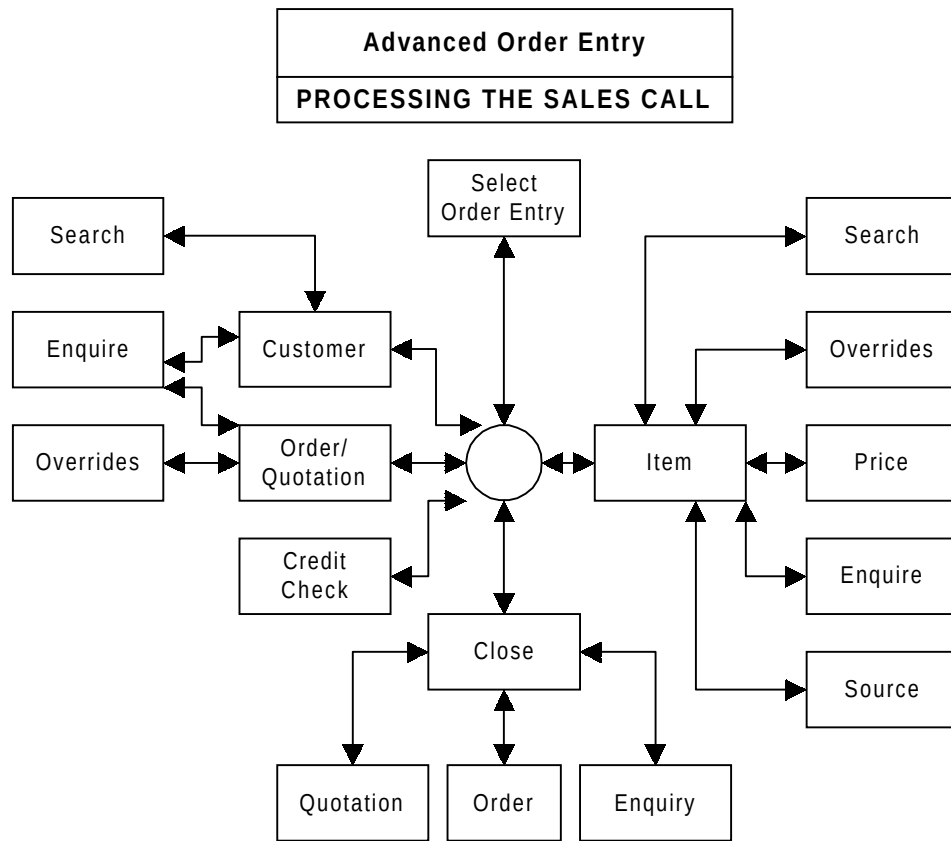
With the conflicting pressures of improved customer service and reduced inventory levels, it is vital that all the possible ways of sourcing are examined during the sales call, and realistic promises are made. It is possible to source an order line from:

- The normal stockroom used to supply the customer
- Any other allowed stockroom
- An alternative item
- Reserve against an incoming purchase order
- Raise a back to back purchase order via a requisition for the sales order line
- Raise a purchase order via a requisition for direct delivery to the customer

During the sourcing process it is possible to allocate specific lots of an item to the order. At the end of the sales call it must be closed and the result recorded. The possible results are:

- An order
- A quotation (including an enquiry)

During the close procedure, additional charges may be added and whole order discounts calculated.

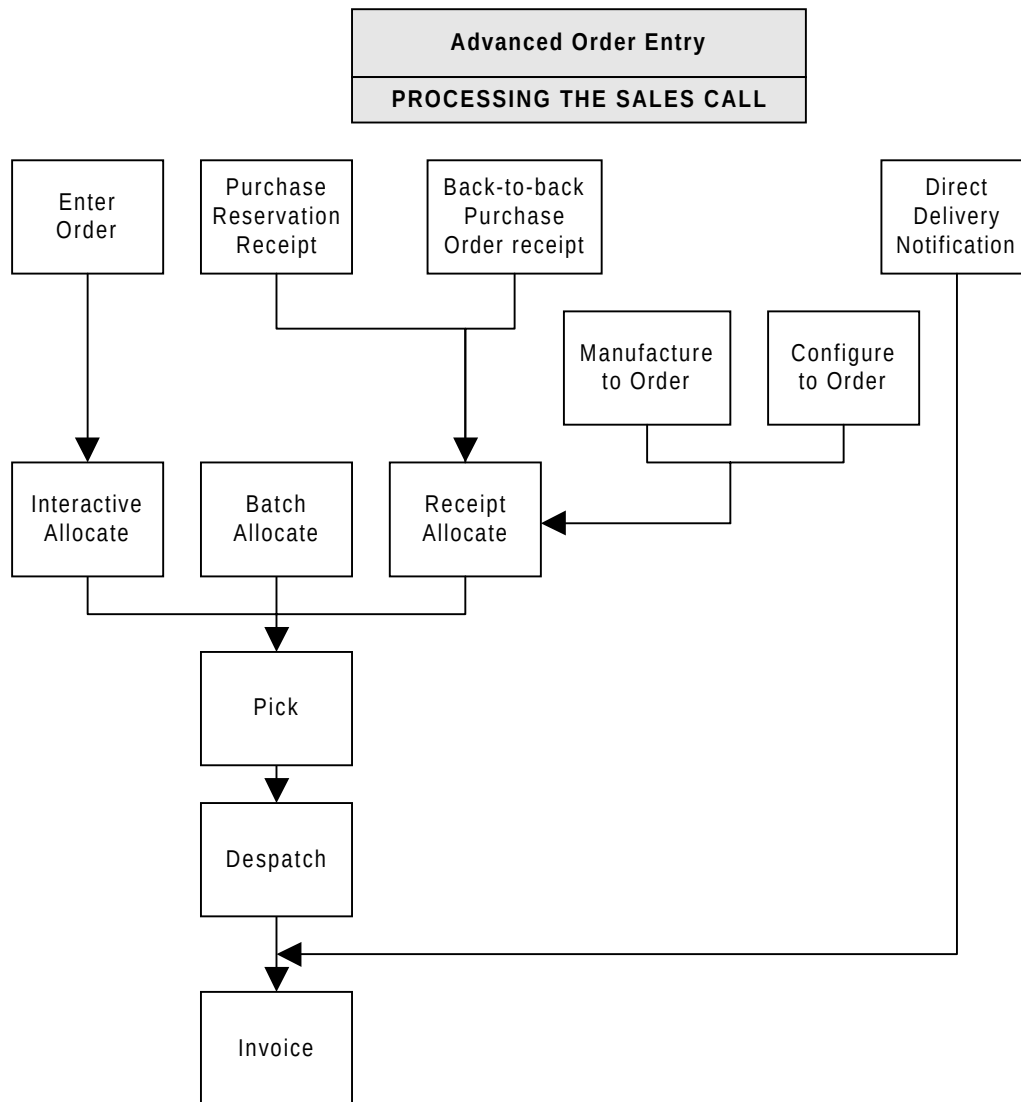


Progressing Orders

Once an order has been taken, stock needs to be allocated. This can be done in a number of ways:

- During order entry, if stock is available it can be allocated. This includes the allocation of a specific lot. Stock from outstanding supply orders can be allocated to a sales order.
- Manual allocation can be used at any time to allocate stock specifically to an order.
- When a receipt is booked for a purchase to order or direct delivery order, stock is automatically allocated to the appropriate sales orders.
- When a receipt is booked for a make-to-order or a configure-to-order, stock is automatically allocated to the appropriate works orders.

Having allocated stock, the order can then be progressed through picking and despatch confirmation, which results in an invoice request being generated. In the case of direct delivery, when notification of delivery is recorded for the purchase order, the associated sales order is updated and the invoice request generated.



Advanced Order Entry Structure

The following diagram illustrates the key stages in the order entry process. From the diagram you can see that the module is designed so that, after opening, the order entry process is controlled from a base screen. Order lines are entered in the base screen and all further processing is selected from and returns to the base screen.

